

OPEN SOURCE · CANADA (US EXPERIMENTAL) · RUNS ON YOUR MACHINE

taxjson

Your broker's CSV in. Schedule 3 out. Capital gains, dividends and the superficial-loss rule computed the way the CRA defines them — across every account you own — with every rule citing its source.

```
bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://taxjson.com/install.sh)"
```

taxjson.com · github.com/taxjson/taxjson · MIT

THE PROBLEM

The slip your broker files is not your cost basis

A T5008 reports proceeds per account. The Income Tax Act taxes you on **one average cost per security across all your accounts**, denies losses when any affiliated account — your RRSP included — bought the same thing within 30 days, and folds option premiums, splits, spin-offs and return of capital into that cost. Nobody's statement does that math for you.

Cross-account pooling

s.47: one ACB pool per identical property. A US listing and its TSX listing are the same pool; a CDR is not.

Superficial losses

s.54 / s.40(2)(g): a loss is denied if you *or an affiliated person* bought within ± 30 days and still holds. Denied into an RRSP, it is gone for good.

Everything that moves cost

Assignments (IT-479R), splits, spin-offs (s. 86.1), mergers with elections, ROC, reinvested distributions — in the right order, on the settlement date.

Spreadsheets get the easy 90% right. The other 10% is where reassessments come from.

WHAT IT DOES

Three steps, all on disk

inputs/

Broker CSV exports per account: IBKR, Questrade, RBC, Webull, Kraken, Coinbase — plus plain-text `.tt` for anything else



taxjson run

Parse · convert at the Bank of Canada rate per settlement date · pool identical securities · corporate actions with elections · superficial-loss pass across taxable and registered accounts



reports/

Per-account summaries, the wash radar, harvest candidates, T1135, a tax estimate, Schedule 3 / Form 8949 rows — and the broker cross-check

One config file

`taxjson.toml` : year, country, province, base currency, one section per account with its type (taxable / sheltered) and the broker positions files to check against.

Row accounting

Every parser accounts for every row it reads. Rows it recognises but does not translate are counted and named — never silently dropped.

Traceable numbers

`taxjson audit` recomputes every disposition from the parsed broker row through FX, ACB and the wash determination, and ties it out against the reports.

RULES WITH RECEIPTS

Every computation names its source

RULE	WHAT TAXJSON DOES	SOURCE
Identical properties	One average-cost pool per security across accounts; cross-listings merged, CDRs kept apart	s.47(1); IT-387R2; T4037
Superficial loss	Denied to the extent an affiliated account acquired in the 61-day window and still holds; the RRSP/TFSA is affiliated; denied-into-plan is permanent	s.54, s.40(2)(g)(i), s.53(1)(f), s.251.1(1)(g)
Disposition date	Settlement date, including at year end	T4037
Foreign currency	Bank of Canada rate on each settlement date, never an annual average	Folio S5-F4-C1
Options	A written option's premium is a gain in the year written; a buy-back is a loss in its own year; an assignment folds the premium into the shares. <code>option-boundary</code> says when a filed year needs a T1-ADJ	s.49(1)–(4); IT-479R
Corporate actions	Splits, spin-offs, mergers with the rollover election recorded and a filing reminder at every run; ROC reduces ACB	s.86.1, s.85.1, s.53(2)(h)
US (experimental)	FIFO, §1091 wash sales with basis and holding-period carry, IRA repurchases permanent, Form 8949 codes	§1091, Reg. 1.1091-1, Rev. Rul. 2008-5

The full map — including what is deliberately *not* modelled and the provision it skips — is REFERENCES.md. A rule that disagrees with its source is a bug; that is the most useful issue the project can receive.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A loss you cannot claim

What happened

The margin account sells 400 shares at a loss on February 3. On February 10 the RRSP buys 200 of the same stock, and still holds them on March 5.

What the slip says

A capital loss on 400 shares. The spreadsheet agrees.

What the Act says

An affiliated person acquired 200 identical shares inside the 61-day window and still owns them at its end: the loss on those 200 is superficial (s.54). The ACB bump goes to the RRSP — where it is worthless. Permanently denied. Shares the RRSP held before the window would not have counted.

NOTE: superficial loss – 200 sh denied (permanently: replacement property held in rrsp)
loss sale 2026-02-03 · trigger lot 2026-02-10 (rrsp) · window end 2026-03-05

Only a tool that sees every account at once can get this right. That is the whole design.

Checked against the one thing that cannot lie

Internal reports can all agree and still be wrong. `taxjson sanity` compares the positions the books say you hold with the positions your broker's own export says you hold, account by account. Any difference is a trade that has not reached the CSV yet, or a booking problem — there is no third kind.

5,000+ tests

Every fix lands with a regression test that failed before it. No mocks for tax math.

Three property fuzzers

Conservation of gains under the wash rule, custody-transfer netting, split-during-settlement books — thousands of random ledgers per run.

Eight audit rounds

Adversarial reviews, statutory scenarios by hand, parser coverage on real exports, a pre-release security audit. Every finding reproduced, fixed, pinned.

Published limits

KNOWN_ISSUES.md lists what is out of scope and what to do by hand, with the citation.

COMMANDS

One pipeline, a few dozen views on it

Build the books

- `init` scaffold a project
- `fetch` Questrade / IBKR activity
- `run` the whole pipeline + broker check
- `elect` corporate-action elections

Read the numbers

- `sum` the year, by account
- `list` / `shares` positions
- `events` / `trades` / `divs` the rows
- `audit` the justification

Before you trade

- `wash-radar` safe-to-sell dates
- `sell-check` / `buy-check`
- `harvest` losses worth taking
- `scan` tax-efficiency lint

Before you file

- `checklist` every step, auto-detected
- `form-export` Schedule 3 / 8949
- `reconcile-slips` / `t1135` / `carryover`
- `option-boundary` / `close-year`

Every command takes `--help`; most take `--json`. `taxjson redact` strips identifiers from a real export so it can be shared as a parser sample.

Nothing personal leaves the machine

Local by construction

Parsing, pooling and the wash pass run on your computer. The pipeline's only network calls are FX rates (Bank of Canada, its noon rate before March 2017; Yahoo only before May 2007) and crypto prices for unpriced rows — both switchable off with `TAXJSON_OFFLINE=1`. `SECURITY.md` lists every egress.

No credentials stored

Broker fetch uses your own token file; it is never written into a project or sent anywhere but that broker.

The project guards itself

A personal-data scan runs in every gate and as the pre-push hook, fails closed, and reads a private denylist kept outside the repository. Redacted exports keep every row shape and drop the identifiers `redact` recognises — review before sharing.

Zero runtime dependencies in the core. A tax tool has to be trustworthy before it is clever.

SCOPE

Canada is the product. The US engine is a draft.

Canada — supported

Average-cost ACB, superficial-loss rule across accounts, settlement-date timing, options, corporate actions with elections, T1135, Schedule 3, instalments and a marginal-rate estimate with provincial tables. Validated against two years of real multi-account books and the brokers' positions.

US — experimental

FIFO, §1091 wash sales, short/long-term, Form 8949 codes and a TXF export. Implemented and unit-tested, never validated on a real account. It says so at every run. Real US exports — redacted — are the way to change that.

Honest labelling costs nothing. A tax tool that overclaims loses the only thing it has.

BROKERS

Reads the exports you already have

BROKER	FORMAT	NOTES
Interactive Brokers	Activity / Flex statement CSV	Trades, options, corporate actions, transfers, fees, dividends; Flex auto-fetch
Questrade	Activity CSV	Trades, DRIP, cash-in-lieu, transfers; REST auto-fetch and live positions
RBC Direct Investing	Activity export	Trades, dividends with withholding
Webull	Trading Summary CSV	Trades and options (BUY/SELL rows only); no income — T5 interest and dividends go in as <code>.tt</code> lines
Kraken · Coinbase	Ledgers / transaction history	Trades, rewards, sends and withdrawals as custody evidence
Anything else	<code>.tt</code> plain text · generic CSV mapping	Ten-line files a human can write and read

Help wanted: Wealhtsimple, TD Direct, BMO InvestorLine, CIBC Investor's Edge, Scotia iTRADE, National Bank Direct, Qtrade, Desjardins. A parser is an afternoon's work given one real export — `taxjson redact` makes sharing one safe.

INSTALL

Your first books in ten minutes

```
bash -c "$(curl -fsSL https://taxjson.com/install.sh)"
```

Installs the latest release into its own Python environment and links `taxjson` onto your PATH. Needs git and Python 3.9+, nothing else. Re-run to upgrade.

```
mkdir -p ~/taxes/2026 && cd ~/taxes/2026
taxjson init --country canada      # writes taxjson.toml and inputs/
# drop broker CSVs into inputs/margin/, inputs/rrsp/, ...
taxjson run                        # books, reports, wash pass, broker check
taxjson sum                       # the realized-gains summary
taxjson wash-radar                 # "can I sell this at a loss today?"
```

WHERE IT GOES

Roadmap

More Canadian brokers

Driven by redacted real exports from users. One parser per afternoon, each with the row-accounting contract.

Rules retail investors hit

Non-eligible dividends and T3 box splits, DRIP fractions, the s.39(4) election, CNIL — whichever real exports show first.

US validation

The engine exists; it needs a real account. The label comes off when the numbers have been checked against one.

1.0

PyPI, a frozen CLI, and the interchange contract with portfolio tools written down.

taxjson.com · github.com/taxjson/taxjson · MIT · not tax advice — a calculator that shows its work.